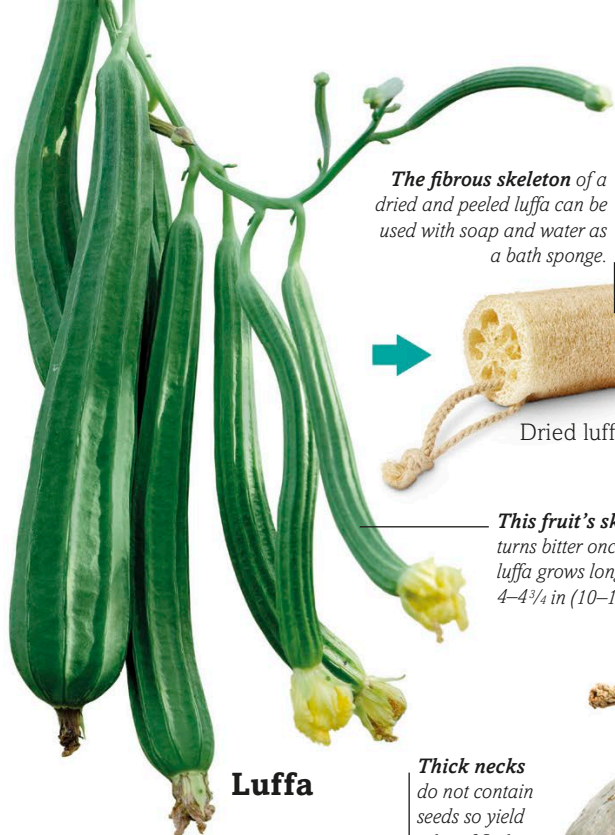




The fibrous skeleton of a dried and peeled luffa can be used with soap and water as a bath sponge.



Dried luffa

This fruit's skin turns bitter once the luffa grows longer than 4-4 3/4 in (10-12 cm).

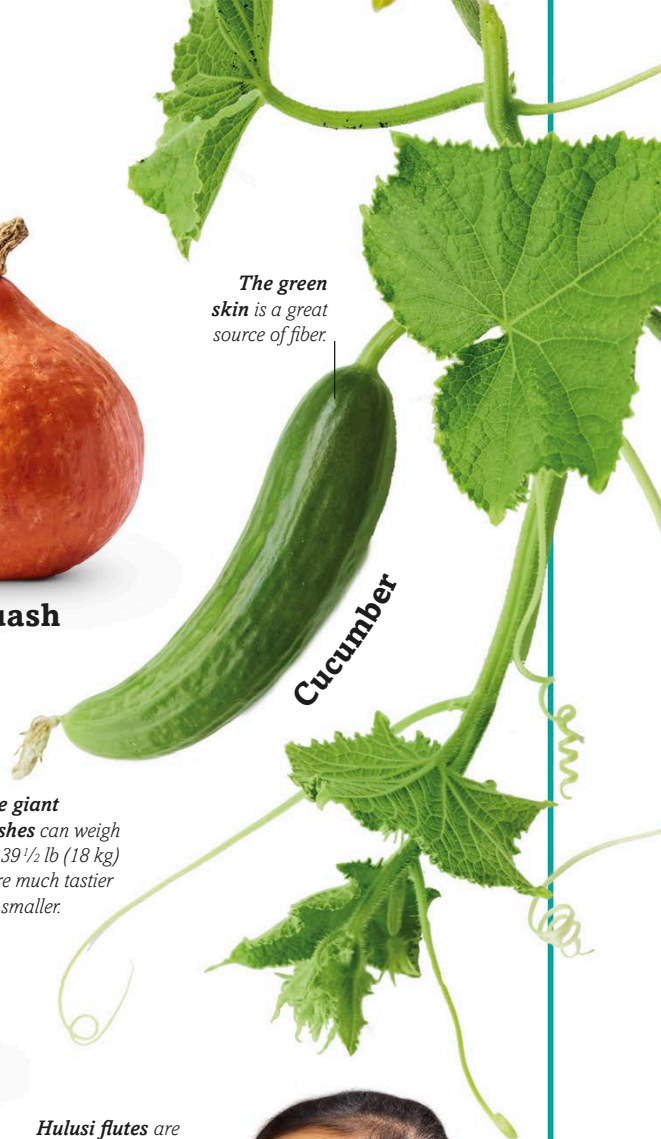
Luffa

The teardrop-shaped fruits taste like chestnuts and are popular in Japan.



Hubbard squash

The green skin is a great source of fiber.



Cucumber

Thick necks do not contain seeds so yield a lot of flesh.



Butternut squash



Blue Hubbard squash

These giant squashes can weigh up to 39 1/2 lb (18 kg) but are much tastier when smaller.



Pattypan squashes

Long necks can stretch to more than 35 in (90 cm).



Tromboncino

Shaped like a flying saucer, these fruits are a slightly sweeter version of a zucchini.

Hulusi flutes are traditional Chinese instruments made of a gourd and three bamboo pipes.



Gourd

as **green pumpkins** and **Hubbard squashes**. Most of these fruits are cooked and eaten as savory dishes such as soups and stews, but some sweeter varieties, including **pumpkin** and **butternut squash**, are also baked into cakes and pies. **Cucumbers** are typically eaten

raw or pickled. Edible **pattypan squashes** are popular fall decorations, while other squashes with hard skins, known as **gourds**, can be dried and used to make everyday items such as jars, bottles, or even musical instruments, including maracas, flutes, and drums.